2025

UNESCO GLOBAL YOUTH HACKATHON



“Ama llulla, ama suwa, ama qilla"
Do not lie, do not steal, do not be lazy

Team Members:

Vania Pachas
Ariana Alburqueque
Astrid Cervantes

Lima, Perú

“AMA LLULLA”
GUARDIANS OF TRUTH

1) INTRODUCTION

Digital disinformation and online risks are growing problems in Peru, especially among youth. According to Peru’s National Institute of Statistics and Informatics (INEI), during the first quarter of 2024, **72% of children and adolescents** between 6 and 17 years old used the internet. This widespread access, while full of opportunities, also exposes them to significant risks. For example, just in 2024, more than 42,000 cybercrime complaints were reported in the country, with fraud being the most common offense (Sidpol, 2024).

Young people are particularly vulnerable, as much of the information they consume comes from memes, short videos, or chain messages that are rarely verified before being shared. This early exposure is concerning, since children between 10 and 12 years old have become the most vulnerable group to online risks such as grooming, with limited ability to recognize or avoid dangerous situations (Aldeas Infantiles, 2025).

Moreover, according to the survey “Risks in the Virtual Environment”, conducted in ten regions of Peru, **61% of children and teengers** have experienced cyberbullying, and 23% have participated in viral challenges. Compounding the problem, 40% of them do not know where to turn if they encounter danger online.

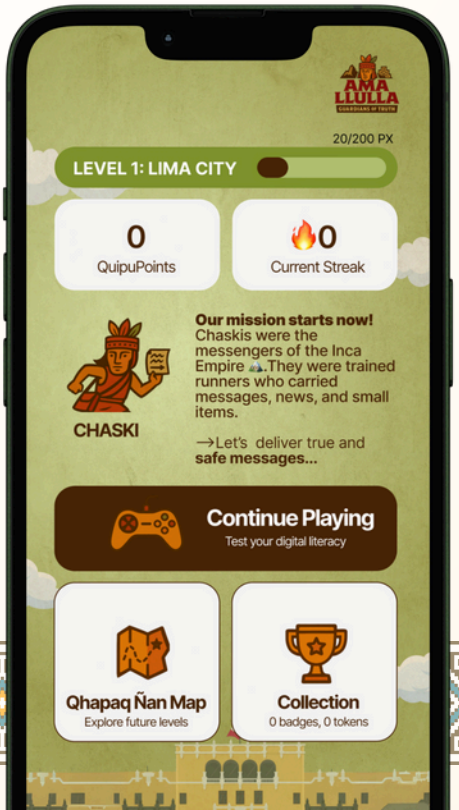
2) PROBLEM

Currently, educational initiatives addressing the problematics mentiones above, tend to be non-interactive and mostly limited to theoretical lectures that fail to connect with the cultural context or digital dynamics in which young people live, creating a gap between their high digital consumption and their low critical capacity to discern what is true from what is false. Without solid critical tools.

3) SOLUTION

In response, we developed ***Ama Llulla: Guardians of Truth***, a **mobile game app** inspired by the Andean principle *Ama Llulla*, which means “Do not lie.” The app is designed to equip children and teenagers with the critical thinking skills needed to analyze online content, identify misinformation, and make safer decisions in their digital lives.

By combining interactive gameplay with Peru’s cultural identidy and values, Ama Llulla bridges the gap between entertainment and education, offering a practical and engaging tool to strengthen media literacy among youth.



TARGET AUDIENCE

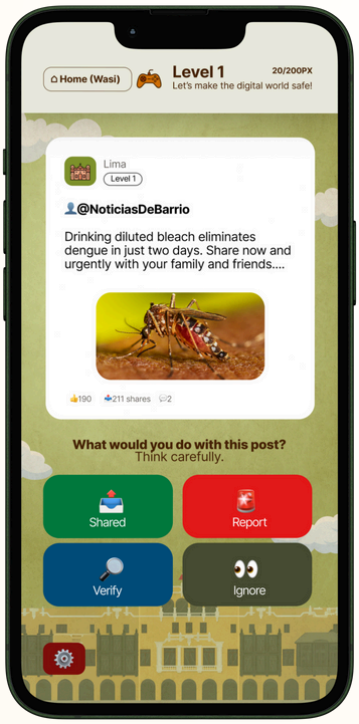
The project targets pre-adolescents and adolescents between 11 and 15 years old. They navigate social networks daily as their main source of entertainment and information, but usually without training in media literacy. This lack of preparation makes them susceptible to grooming, online harassment, and exposure to hate speech or manipulative content.

4) ABOUT THE GAME

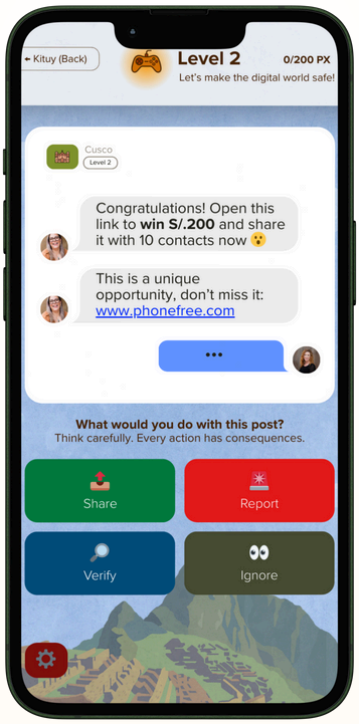
Ama Llulla is a narrative-arcade mobile game where players act as Digital *Chaskis (*highly trained, relay-running messengers of the Inca Empire) traveling across different regions of Peru to detect and stop disinformation, deepfakes, and hate speech.

The game features simulated digital publications based on real-life scenarios, such as:

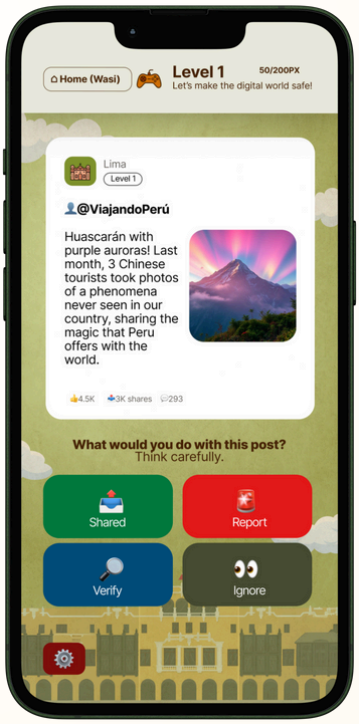
- Viral headlines that may be misleading.
- Clickbait posts with exaggerated claims.
- Manipulated photos or videos.
- Offensive comments on social media
- Online messages containing false information.



Sample scenario N°1



Sample scenario N°2



Sample scenario N°3

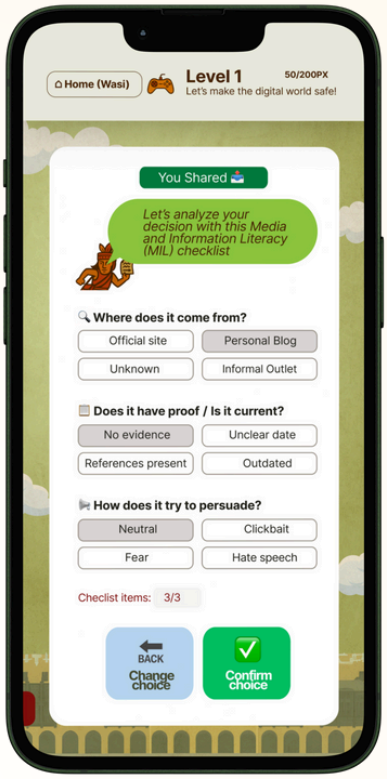
For each short scenario, players need to decide whether to **verify, share, report, or ignore** the content they have seen. These scenarios cover diverse topics such as health tips, environmental issues, celebrity news, politics, and everyday rumors, reflecting the variety of content children and teens actually encounter while navigating the internet.

Players are not left alone in this process. Before making their choice, they must go through a short 3-step multiple choice checklist that guides their analysis of the post:

1. **Check the source** – Who published this information? Is it from a reliable or verified page?
2. **Examine the evidence** – Does the post include data, images, or links that can be verified, or does it rely on exaggerated claims?
3. **Look for manipulation** – Are the words, pictures, or tone designed to create fear, anger, or urgency?

Only after completing this checklist players confirm their decision. Then, they receive immediate feedback on the action they chose, along with tips and explanations about why that choice was right or wrong.

This approach makes the game less about quick clicks and more about practicing critical thinking. By repeating the steps, players build the habit of slowing down, analyzing, and making safer choices.



MIL Checklist screen

GAMIFICATION STRATEGY

Players simulate travelling along the *Qhapaq Ñan* (the Inca Trail), where each stop on the trail represents a region of Peru, for example, Cusco or Lima. These regions act as levels or maps that must be unlocked along the way. For every correct or incorrect decision, they earn or lose QuipuPoints, allowing them to advance through the trail, and unlock **badges**, and **cultural tokens**, making their progress a cultural and fun challenge.



Qhapac Ñam



Unlocked region



Badges & Tokens



Badge Example

EXTRA FEATURES

The app includes a **“Get Informed”** section where players can find official helplines, hotlines and websites from trusted national authorities. This feature ensures that users know where to report and seek help if they ever face cases of grooming, online harassment or other type of digital violation.

In adittion, to highlight Peru’s heritage, “Ama Llulla” incorporates **Quechua words** into game commands and provides short explanations of cultural terms such as *Quipu* and *Qhapaq Ñan*. This adds an educational layer that connects players with the richness of local traditions.



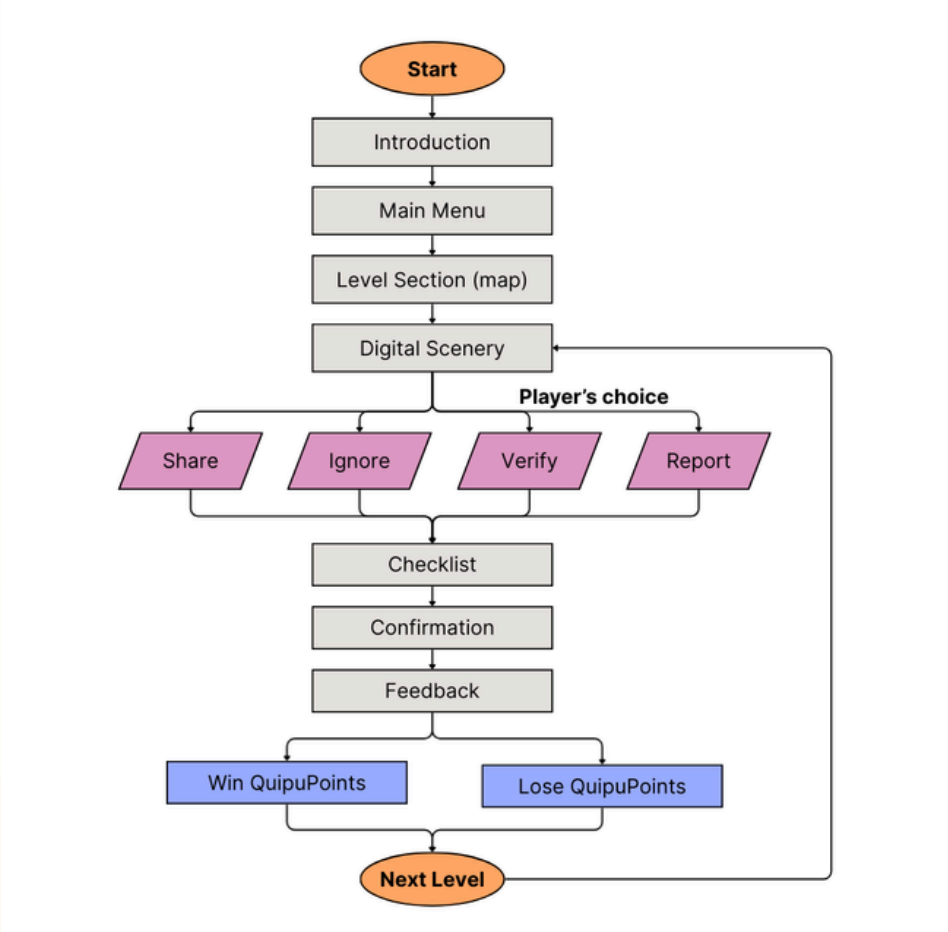
Information screen



Quechua

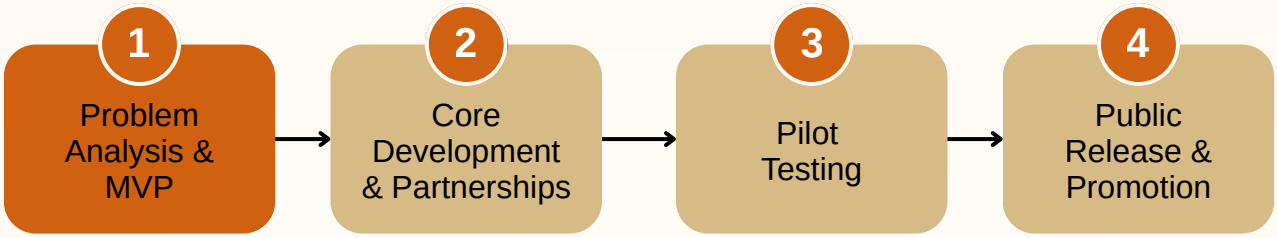
FLOWCHART

The following flowchart shows the player’s path in *Ama Llulla: Guardians of Truth*, guiding the user through key stages: game introduction and objectives, main menu access, level selection on the map, and a simulated scenario presenting digital threat cases.



5) APP DEVELOPMENT TIMELINE

Ama Llula's timeline for success and development:



Phase	Activities	Duration
Phase 1: Problem Analysis & MVP **(Current)**	• Conduct problem definition and target audience • Interview students to validate needs and expectations • Establish core gameplay, features and educational design principles. • Build a **responsive Figma prototype (MVP)** with key features and user flow.	2 months (Aug–Sep 2025)
Phase 2: Core Development & Partnerships	• Gather feedback from hackathon judges and peers • Call for volunteer software developers and UI/UX designers from Peruvian universities. • Build the functional mobile application (Android/iOS) • Look for potential partnerships with organizations (MINEDU, Aldeas Infantiles, NGOs)	3 months (Oct–Dec 2025)
Phase 3: Pilot Testing	• Deploy pilot version in selected school(s) for controlled testing. • Collect feedback from students, teachers, and partner institutions. • Improve gameplay, UI/UX, and educational flow based on results.	2 months (Jan–Feb 2026)
Phase 4: Public Release & Promotion	• Publish on Google Play Store and Apple App Store. • Drive adoption in schools via campaigns with MINEDU and Aldeas Infantiles. • Organize launch events and secure media coverage. • Monitor analytics (downloads, engagement, retention).	3 months (Mar–May 2026)

6) PROJECT OBJECTIVES



- **Increase Media and Information Literacy good practices:** Pre-teens and teenagers will learn to recognize online risks, strengthen critical thinking, verify sources, identify misinformation, and make informed decisions through interactive challenges, dynamic storytelling, and a gamified experience.
- **Facilitate access to reliable information:** The game provides digital resources, official reporting lines, and advisory channels from government and civil society institutions so users can learn about MIL and digital safety.
- **Ensure accessibility and inclusivity:** With offline mode, simple interfaces, and inclusive language, the game reaches youth from diverse backgrounds, promotes digital equity, and empowers excluded communities.
- **Reinforce cultural identity:** The integration of Andean principles (*Ama Llulla*), alongside elements of Peru 's cultural heritage (landscapes, traditional characters, and native languages) encourages youth to embrace their roots with pride.

7) FEASIBILITY

The project is feasible thanks to accessible online tools such as **Figma**, which allows the creation of responsive prototypes to guide app development without high expertise. Low-code platforms will then support the actual application development efficiently.

Another strength is that the initiative is led by youth who have recently gone through the same stage as the target audience. This provides a close, **firsthand understanding** of the users' needs and digital habits, making the experience relevant and empathetic.

The work plan is organized into stages (see timeline) enabling progress based on feedback. Additionally, the involvement of volunteer university students with expertise in programming and UI/UX design reduces production costs while fostering collaboration.

8) PROJECT OBJECTIVES



Ama Llulla is designed for long-term impact through continuous content updates, collaborations with educational and cultural institutions, and inclusive access for diverse communities. Its phased development: early student validation, partnerships with universities and NGOs, pilot testing in schools, and wider public release, ensures the project remains scalable, and socially and economically sustainable over time.

9) CONCLUSION

Ama Llulla: Guardians of Truth represents an innovative proposal that bridges Andean cultural heritage with Media and Information Literacy (MIL) education, offering teenagers a playful yet powerful tool to strengthen their critical thinking skills and recognize misinformation in their daily lives. By combining free digital tools, youth-led creativity, and academic collaboration, the project demonstrates both feasibility and long-term sustainability.

This game app has the potential to become a transformative educational resource, helping shape a generation of informed, critical, and culturally connected youth not just in Peru, but in different developing countries, capable of navigating the digital world with confidence and responsibility.

IMPORTANT LINKS

- **Responsive Prototype** (click here to try our app functional prototype)
- **Game frames** (click here to see our screens design)
- **App pitch**



Ama Llulla: Guardians of Truth is a project by:



Vania Pachas



Ariana Alburqueque



Astrid Cervantes

REFERENCES

National Institute of Statistics and Informatics. (2024, June 10). *State of childhood and adolescence: January–February–March 2024* [Report]. INEI. https://www.gob.pe/en/institucion/inei/informes-publicaciones/5645453-estado-de-la-ninez-y-adolescencia-enero-febrero-marzo-2024

RPP News. (2025, March 7). *Cybercrime in Peru increased by 40% in 2024: More than 42,000 complaints of computer crimes*. RPP. https://rpp.pe/peru/actualidad/fraudes-digitales-y-suplantacion-de-identidad-alarmantes-cifras-de-la-pnp-revelan-el-impacto-de-la-ciberdelincuencia-en-peru-noticia-1620466

SOS Children's Villages Peru. (2025, June 25). *9 out of 10 children believe that digital risks can lead to suicide*. ConectadaSOS. https://www.aldeasinfantiles.org.pe/noticias/9-de-10-ninos-creen-riesgos-digitales-suicidio

SOS Children's Villages Peru. (2023, August 31). *Six out of ten children and adolescents have experienced cyberbullying*. https://www.aldeasinfantiles.org.pe/noticias/seis-de-cada-diez-ninas,-ninos-y-adolescentes-han